This is the second group milestone for the Project.

Note that due to the Chinese New Year holidays, the presentation for this deliverable should be recorded and uploaded with your slides as we will not be holding in-person tutorials for the week.

Following a user-centered design approach requires a deep understanding of the user group, their current practices, and their needs. Consider carefully the approaches to user research and requirements discovery discussed in lecture in Weeks 4 and 5 and decide **what** you need to find out about your target user group, and **how** you will go about your **user research** phase.

Note that for this project, we expect each team member to gather information from **one (1)** member of the target user group for interviews. If you are doing surveys, you should get roughly **five (5) to ten (10)** respondents per team member. You **do not need** to do both interviews and surveys. Think about what is most appropriate for the questions you need answered. If you're not sure, ask during your presentation and your tutor will help you to adjust your plan.

You will present your responses during tutorial in Week 6. The slide deck will consist of **4 slides**, one per point:

1. A brief summary of the **focus** of your project, in case the audience has forgotten
2. What **questions** do you have about your target user group that you need answered to help you understand the problem space?
   *Note that here we are looking for the **high-level questions** you need to have answered about your target user group, **not the specific questions** you are going to ask as part of your interviews or surveys.*
3. What **data gathering techniques** will you use about finding out more about their **current practice**?
4. Provide **details** about **how** you will use these techniques: **Who** will you talk to? How **many**? **What** will you ask them to do? How does this help you to **answer** the questions you have about your users?

Summary of the focus

Problem (Root Cause):

Household conflict in Singapore's co-living spaces stems from ***divergent personal standards***, causing social friction, awkwardness and high manual overhead, which is further exacerbated by fragmented communication that is scattered across platforms (e.g. Whatsapp, Splitwise, banking apps for transferring money).

Solution:

A centralized Co-living Mediator Dashboard that depersonalizes household management. It shifts responsibility from the individual to a transparent, automated system.

Key Value Proposition:

By automating the "social labor" of reminders and consolidating fragmented data, the system preserves roommate relationships and eliminates the friction caused by efficient, subjective expectations.

High-level questions

(honestly idk what is counted as a “high-level” question… so I just wrote everything down here and yall can have a look)

- How do housemates currently handle disagreements regarding shared responsibilities, and at what point does a "reminder" turn into "social friction"?
- Which types of shared data (bills, chores, house rules, or guest logs) are most critical to access quickly, and which cause the most confusion when lost in chat history?
- What level of "proof" (e.g., receipt photos, timestamps) is required for users to feel that a shared system is fair and reliable?
- Why do current general-purpose tools (WhatsApp/Splitwise) fail to sustain long-term household harmony for this specific demographic?
- How do housemates define "clean" or "done," and how do these differing subjective thresholds lead to resentment?
- What are the specific triggers that cause a housemate to stop cooperating (e.g., feeling "nagged," perceived unfairness, or lack of visibility)?
- What is the lived experience of "the reminder"? At what point does a request for cooperation transform into perceived social aggression (nagging)?
- How is "fairness" conceptualized in a shared space, and how do housemates track their own contributions versus others'?
- Why do current informal systems (WhatsApp/Splitwise) fail to resolve the underlying emotional tension when a task is left undone?

Data gathering techniques

Interviews:

Instead of general questions, we will ask users to describe a specific, recent "explosion" or "awkward silence" regarding chores or bills. This identifies the root cause of the friction.

How to use these techniques

Technique	Participants	The "What" & "Why"
Interviews	3-5 "Conflict-Heavy" Households.	What: Interview housemates separately about the same issue. Why: To identify where their standards and perceptions of cooperation differ.